

DAY 9: SLASH YOUR GROCERY BILL

Whenever I talk to women and families about saving money, lowering groceries is almost always at the top of the list. Why? Because the majority of them spend hundreds, if not thousands, of dollars on food each month, creating a huge financial strain for already maxed out budgets.

As food prices rise and life gets a little busier every year, we have less time than ever before to scout out the best savings. And if you try to eat healthy or have a specific food allergy, forget it. The sky-high prices of organic fruits and veggies, not to mention anything labeled gluten-free, double and triple your grocery bill, almost like an unlawful punishment for being conscious about what we feed our families.

My grocery budget has experienced its own financial roller coaster from month to month. Some weeks, I do really well with my spending, and others, not so much. I most often go over budget because I stop paying attention to sales and focus instead on getting in and out of the store as quickly as possible. I don't particularly like grocery shopping if you can't tell!

It's not until I pull out the crumpled receipt from my pocket and enter it into my Expense Tracker that I clearly see the results of my laziness. Once again, I've gone over budget, and guilt becomes that old familiar wakeup call. It's time to get back up and try again, no matter how hard or impossible it might be to start over.

The thing is, I know it's more than feasible to cut costs in this area. I've done it, and I'm going to teach you how to do it too. Because even though we have to eat, we don't have to eat expensively. Just a few shopping habits have the potential to drastically reduce your spending, and on the flipside, give you immediate savings. These creative ways to slash your grocery bill make the biggest difference!

1. SHOP YOUR PANTRY